day and his name did not figure in the police list of journalists present in Amritsar. [13]

The main army action at the Golden Temple commenced on 5 June 1984. In his address to his troops before they were ordered to enter the Golden Temple, Maj. Gen. Brar identified Bhindranwale as 'the enemy' who had taken control of the Golden Temple complex, which now had to be wrested out of his control. They were also told that while doing so they must not fire either at the Harmandir Sahib or the Akal Takht without direct orders. The operation was launched at around 10 p.m. simultaneously from two sides, and the fighting that ensued continued till 7.30 a.m. the next day.

In a separate operation the same evening, the BSF and CRPF attacked militants hiding in Hotel Temple View and Brahm Boota Akhara, respectively, on the south-west fringes of the temple complex. By 10 p.m. both these buildings were under the forces' control.

One of the tasks assigned to Lt Gen. Sundarji by the government was to 'prevent internecine fighting' between the two major groups – Bhindranwale's group living in the Akal Takht and the moderate group of Akali Dal leaders, headed by Harchand Singh Longowal, living in Teja Singh Samundri Hall and the adjacent hostel complexes. [14] It was decided to segregate the two areas and clear the hostel-cum-SGPC office complex, comprising Guru Ram Das Sarai, Teja Singh Samundri Hall and Guru Nanak Niwas, of their inmates simultaneously with the clearance of buildings in the temple complex, including the Akal Takht. Most of the pilgrims and supporters of the Akali morcha and Akali Dal leaders had taken refuge in the hostel complex, where water and electricity connections had been cut. To allow the troops to enter the hostel complex, its strong southern gate had to be broken with the help of tanks.

The army entered Teja Singh Samundri Hall at about 1 a.m. on 6 June. Both Longowal and Gurcharan Singh Tohra, along with some other functionaries of the SGPC, were asked to stay put in the office room. One of the persons who surrendered was Harminder Singh Sandhu, general secretary of the All India Sikh Students Federation and a suspected Indian intelligence agent. He was reportedly sent by